



## **Cambodia University of Technology and Science**

### **Publication Manual**

#### **1. Types of CamTech Publication**

The Cambodia University of Technology and Science (CamTech) is one of Cambodia's leading institutions in academic research, both in social and pure science. CamTech aims to stimulate high-quality scientific research, exchange of ideas, debate, and discussion via its own specialist publications, which are under the full control of the academics. CamTech publishes various types of academic papers, which can be distinguished into two broad categories. The first category consists of CamTech Correspondence, Science and Technology Development, and area-specific scientific journals, all of which welcome contributions from both CamTech's faculty members/academic staff and external researchers, scholars, scientists, professionals, students, and practitioners globally. The article's subjects range from socio-economic development to purely scientific advancement. On the other hand, the second category comprises the CamTech Discussion Paper Series and CamTech Research Report Series, which are mostly academic works written by CamTech's researchers and affiliated members. Similar to area-specific scientific journals, these academic papers can be highly technical as their primary and target audiences are mostly active academics, professors, graduate students, and scholars who are more interested in state-of-the-art literature to advance their theoretical or empirical knowledge about a specific field of study.

#### **CamTech Correspondence**

CamTech Correspondence articles are op-ed articles, commentaries, or short papers that either re-analyze published articles, present findings, or discuss issues of particular interest to the community but are not suitable as standard research articles. Papers submitted to CamTech Correspondence are considered at the discretion of the editor and may be edited for clarity or length but may or may not be subject to a peer-review process. Where an author comments on a previously published article, the first or corresponding author of the original article will be invited to respond, and his or her response may be published as part of the Correspondence. CamTech Correspondence is published on a rolling basis.

## **Science, Technology, and Sustainability Review**

**STS Review** is concerned primarily with the analysis of currently specific social, economic, scientific, and technological development issues and challenges for Cambodia and beyond. It attempts to fill a gap between the interested general public and the academics and is designed to help researchers in both social and pure science keep abreast of the vast flow of academic literature. Therefore, STS Review aims to publish papers that are widely accessible and will serve several goals: to synthesize and integrate central ideas from state-of-the-art literature and thinking; to provide knowledge and reading materials for university-level classroom use, to stimulate cross-fertilization of ideas among academics from various field, and to ask remaining unanswered questions and suggest direction for future research. It should be noted that STS Review is intended to be scholarly but also intelligible to non-specialists without relying heavily on mathematical notation and knowledge. In some cases, it will be appropriate for authors to offer a mathematical derivation, but in most cases, it is more desirable that the authors explain a phenomenon or a formula using logical reasoning and/or link it to intuition.

Articles appearing in the STS Review are normally solicited by the editors, co-editors, or associate editors. However, we welcome unsolicited papers sent by qualified academic researchers. Authors submitting such papers are expected to be experts in the field, with few exceptions. The STS Review is published occasionally and subject to a double-blind peer-review process.

## **Scientific Journals**

CamTech also publishes a number of flagship international scholarly journals on a rolling basis or at a regular interval. Each journal article should comprise between 6,000 and 8,000 words in length excluding abstract, footnotes, endnotes, and bibliography. CamTech journals features both theoretical and empirical research, systematic review articles, book reviews. Original research articles can be a specific country studies (e.g. Cambodia) or cross-country comparative studies. Papers which describe novel theory and its application to practice (e.g. application of artificial intelligence) are also welcome, as are those which illustrate the transfer of techniques from other disciplines. Reports of carefully executed experimental work or Research Note, which is soundly interpreted are also accepted. Submitted manuscript must undergo a rigorous peer-review process.

## **CamTech Discussion Paper Series**

CamTech Discussion Paper Series is CamTech's publication flagship and influential technical working paper series. Its purpose is to disseminate pre-publication version of high-quality research papers authored by CamTech's fellows, researchers, and faculty or affiliated members to academic community with aims of sharing ideas and eliciting feedback. The discussion papers may be in various stages of completion: first draft, under submission, or in press and forthcoming elsewhere usually in an academic journal. Discussion paper might be copyedited for clarification, but they are not refereed by any qualified reviewer. Additionally, the format other than the cover page is not standardized. With that said, the content of the papers is the sole responsibility of individual authors, and comments on papers or questions should be directed toward the authors.

The authors, however, need to seek approval for publication in CamTech Discussion Paper Series from research director. CamTech Discussion Paper Series might be cited without seeking prior permission from the authors or CamTech per se, and publishing as a discussion paper at CamTech does not preclude subsequent publication in academic journal elsewhere. Nevertheless, authors should be aware that some journals do not accept papers that is published previously as discussion or working papers.

### **CamTech Research Report Series**

CamTech Research Report Series is a type of publication aiming to disseminate basic research results and findings. Such results and findings may derive from descriptive statistics of quantitative survey, qualitative interview or focus group discussion, field visit, lab experiments, commissioned consultancy reports, special reports on specific issues, or rapid assessment. The Research Report is authored by CamTech's fellows, researchers, and faculty or affiliated members but are not necessarily as technical as a discussion paper. The target audience may include public or private sectors, policymakers, academics, development partners, practitioners, and the general public. Therefore, authors should write research report with target audiences in mind. Research report has to undergo double-blind peer-reviewing process and seek approval for publication from research director.

## **2. Reviewing Process**

Peer review system is an integral part of scientific publishing that confirms the validity of the article or manuscript. It also helps to improve the quality of published research study. Likewise, CamTech heavily relies on the peer review process to uphold the quality and validate individual academic work. The initial peer review process is usually completed between six and eight months. All manuscripts or articles including those that are authored by CamTech's staffs and affiliated members submitted for consideration for publication must undergo the similar peer-review process. The peer review process CamTech is practicing can be broadly summarized into six steps as follows

### **Step 1: Submission of Paper**

The corresponding or submitting author submits the paper to CamTech via an online system such as email or Scholar-One Manuscripts.

### **Step 2: Editorial Office Assessment**

Assigned editor reads and checks the paper to screen for papers that are clearly outside the aim and scope, and whether or not the paper is sufficiently original and interesting. If not, the paper may be rejected without being reviewed any further. It should be emphasized that assigned editor

cannot be the author or one of the authors of such paper. If the editor has a possible conflict of interest in assessing the paper, another editor should be assigned to handle it.

The quality of the paper is not, however, assessed at this point, but editor still needs to fundamentally evaluate the paper to determine the appropriate Editorial Board and/or external reviewers. Depending on the necessity and individual availability, CamTech may assign the article to Associate Editors who will handle the peer review at this stage.

### **Step 3: Invitation to Reviewers**

The editor sends invitations to individuals who he or she believes would be appropriate reviewers for the article. As responses are received, further invitations are sent, if necessary, until the required number of acceptances is obtained. Commonly, there should be two reviewers, but there is some variation between articles. Number of reviewers to be invited and selection of a reviewer should be based on the nature of the paper, complexity of the analytical technique or method, reviewer's area of expertise and his or her availability, and current editorial team workload. In addition, editor has to ensure that there can be no potential conflict of interest between authors and reviewers. Quality of articles written by CamTech staffs should be validated by external reviewer. Reviewers should be given a period of three weeks to review an article following their acceptance, but they should also be encouraged to return manuscripts unreviewed if they cannot complete the review within the timeframe and are asked to state any conflict of interest they may have in reviewing the paper. Such a statement does not necessarily disqualify the reviewer or invalidate their comments.

### **Step 4: Reviewing**

Potential reviewers consider and accept the invitation. The reviewer should set time aside to read the paper several times. The first read represent perhaps the most critical work of the peer review process. If major problems such as inappropriateness of study design and method, lack of originality or significance, overgeneralization, or inadequate references are found at this stage, the reviewer may feel comfortable rejecting the paper without further work. Otherwise reviewer should read the paper a few more times and provide detailed point-by-point review which can be aggregated in two categories: major and minor comments. The review should be written in another document rather than on the original manuscript and is then submitted to the editor who will in turn send to author. Reviewer should also send a confidential recommendation to the editor to accept, reject, or request for revision before it is reconsidered.

### **Step 5: Editor's evaluation of the review and make a decision**

The editor considers all the returned reviews and his or her own independent review of the paper before making a decision on initial disposition of the manuscript. If the returned reviews differ largely, the editor may invite an additional reviewer or discuss with the editorial staffs so as to get an extra opinion before making the decision. After such decision is made, the editor then sends an email to the author, indicating the decision and relevant reviewers' comments that may be useful

for him or her to understand the reasons for the decision. Editors have various options when it comes to making a decision about an academic paper. Such decision includes

- **Accept without revision:** the article or manuscript will be published in its original form.
- **Accept with minor revisions:** the article or manuscript will be published once the author has made some minor revision.
- **Accept with major revisions:** the article or manuscript will be published once the author has made some major revision suggested by the reviewers and/or editors.
- **Revise and resubmit:** the article or manuscript needs substantial revision, and it will be reconsidered in another round of decision making once the authors have made some required changes and resubmit their paper.
- **Reject:** the article or manuscript will not be published or reconsidered.

### **Step 6: Publication**

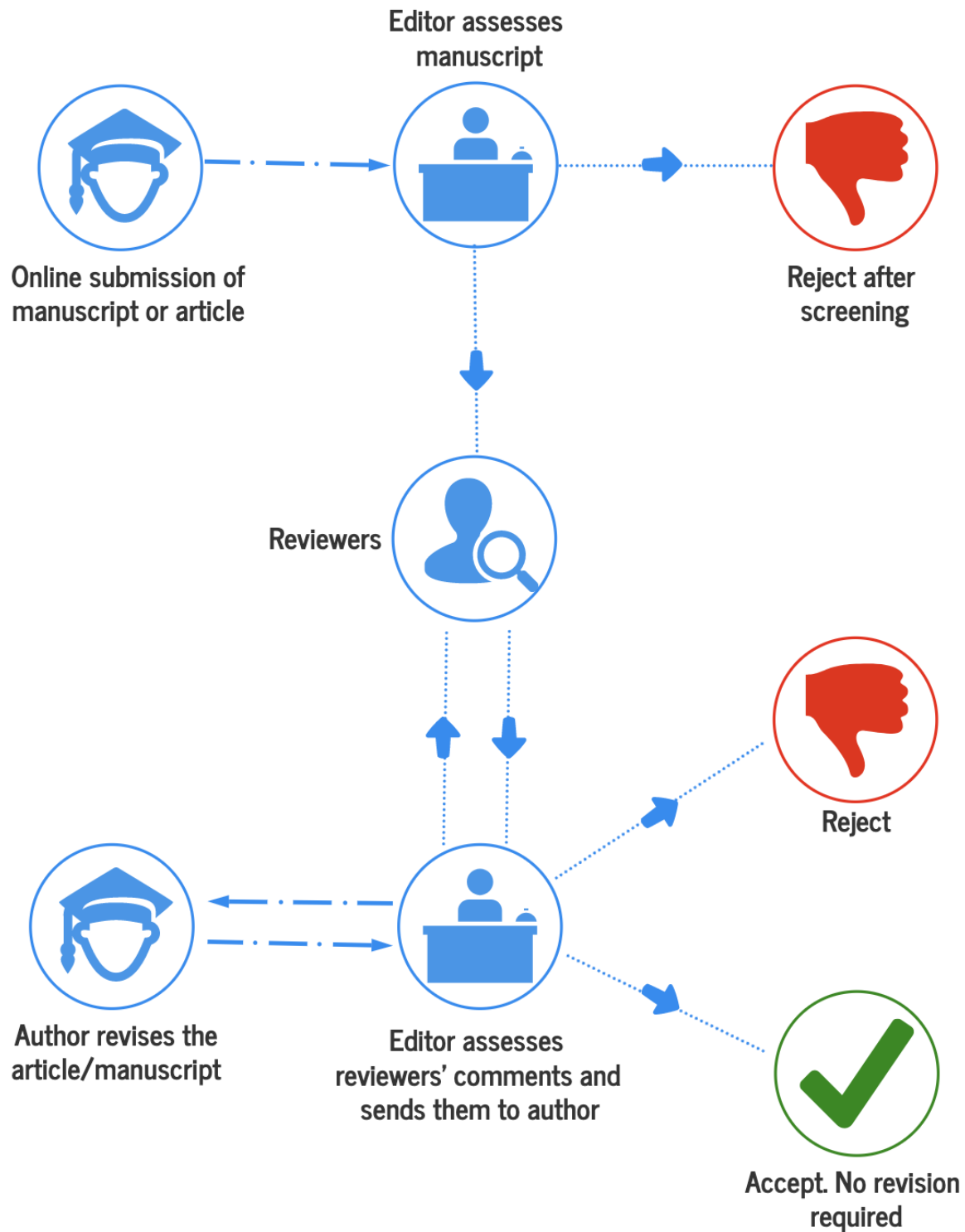
If *accepted*, the first or corresponding author needs to sign on the Transfer of Copyright Agreement before the paper is sent to production. If the article is rejected or sent back for further revision, the editor should include constructive comments from the reviewers to assist the author in improving the quality of his or her article or manuscript. The comments should, however, be the original words of the reviewers, and no alteration or paraphrase should be made otherwise the meaning may be changed or lost.

Meanwhile, reviewers should also be sent an email letting them know the outcome of their review and the decision of the editor so that the reviewers should expect to receive a new version if the paper was sent back for major revision unless the reviewers have decided to opt out of further participation. However, where only minor revision were requested in which case the changes can usually be made quickly, this follow-up re-review might be done only by the editor. In the case that questions seem to remain, manuscript or article should be sent back out to the same reviewers with a copy of the author's response letter.

The author is also given the opportunity to choose not to follow the reviewer's comments and revise the manuscript, but he or she is asked to provide a rationale for that choice or a rebuttal. In either minor or major revision case, author is expected to provide point-by-point response noting how the reviewer's comments were addressed.

This cycle of review may repeat a few times, leading to a final acceptance or to a final rejection if revisions are not or cannot be made.

# Reviewing Process



### **3. Publication Procedure**

To ensure that manuscripts or articles that have successfully completed peer review are published to the highest possible standard, careful planning and preparation of materials are needed. Corresponding author of the accepted manuscript must also liaise with CamTech's publishing office to avoid introducing typographical errors or inconsistency. However, it should be highlighted that making major changes to the accepted manuscript is no longer possible at this stage. If the author or publisher feels that the manuscript may be problematic for any reason, he or she should discuss those concerns with the editor. CamTech's publication procedure is divided into four broad steps as follows:

#### **Step 1: Accepted article received in production**

Accepted manuscript is received by the publishing unit to begin production. However, the production cannot begin until the first or corresponding author has signed on the Transfer of Copyright Agreement and sent back to CamTech's office in charge of research affair. The head of such office will then inform the publishing unit to proceed into step 2.

#### **Step 2: Copyediting and Typesetting**

Accepted manuscript is copyedited by either in-house or freelance copyeditor for style and to improve its clarity and correct grammatical or typographical mistakes. It is done so to bring the standard of the text up to international level that the research study deserves. At this stage, if there is any major revision being made by the copyeditor, he or she needs to notify the author in written communication through the publishing officer. The manuscript should also be typeset after the copyediting. It is the responsible of the publishing officer and the copyeditor to ensure that the text is laid out according to CamTech standard formats.

#### **Step 3: Proofing and corrections**

After the manuscript is copyedited and typeset, it should be sent back to the corresponding author for a final proofreading to correct basic errors and tweaks language if there is any before it is to be published. The author should accurately proofread the article and clearly mark any corrections as soon as possible. If he or she disagrees with any major changes made by the copyeditor, he or she should approach the publishing officer in written communication so that the latter can notify the copyeditor for further process.

#### **Step 4: Article is published**

Once the final draft is received, it should be submitted to the director of research for approval before it is uploaded online and/or sent for printing. No further changes to the article are possible from this point onward. The publishing and the IT office need to ensure that the article is available

online as soon as it is approved for publication. Author should also receive an email alert when his or her article is published for the first time.



## 4 Steps to Publishing a Manuscript to the Highest Possible Standard with CamTech

①



### Article Accepted

Manuscript received at the publisher to begin production.



②



### Copyediting and Typesetting

Copyediting of manuscript for style and grammar.

Typesetting.



③



### Proofing and Corrections

Manuscript is sent back to author via email for proofreading. Author should mark any corrections as soon as possible and send the final version back to publisher for further process.



④

### Article Published Online

Article is published in pdf format online without charge. No further changes are possible.

The print publication of the article may follow this stage. However, online version of the article is fully citable.



#### **4. Distribution**

To promote scientific research and offer students, academic community, and the general public a wider access to scholarly knowledge, CamTech has ensured that most of its publications in digital format are available without charge. In addition, the price of each publication namely books and journal articles in physical form is set at an affordable rate. CamTech also occasionally seeks grants and sponsorship from private sectors and development partners to subsidize the publication cost.

#### **5. Copyright Issues**

When a manuscript or an article is accepted, but before it is processed for publication, first author or authorized co-author has to sign a Transfer of Copyright Agreement which will transfer the copyright from author to CamTech to enable the latter to assure maximum dissemination of the author's work. If the article is a "work made for hire" it must be signed by the employer. After the signing of such agreement, all forms of publication in any language and all media, electronic and otherwise will be the sole property of the Cambodia University of Technology and Science.

Authors, however, retain their authorship and the right to be credited as the author of the article. In addition, authors can make printed copies of their article to use for a lecture or class that they are teaching on a non-commercial purpose or present the article at a meeting or conference. Last but not least, they can share their article using the free digital format with friends, colleagues, and audiences that would like to read their work. Nevertheless, authors are not authorized to distribute printed copies of the article for profit or commercial advantage. The author has the right to republish, post on servers, redistribute to lists and use any component of this work in other works. For others to do so requires prior permission which may be requested from the Cambodia University of Technology and Science's office in charge of research affair.

Authors as well as CamTech are obliged to respect existing Cambodian intellectual copyright law and publication ethics practiced by international academic community.